Reproduction and Extension of StockMixer for Stock Price Forecasting

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***Abstract*—Stock-return forecasting requires models that capture temporal and cross-stock structure while supporting reliable evaluation. This project reproduces released StockMixer configurations and extends the training workflow with exact recording, recoverable checkpoints, execution optimizations, and stock-branch diagnostics. Experiments use supplied NASDAQ arrays containing 1,026 stocks and five features, with a 16-day lookback and one-day prediction horizon. The main comparison covers 21 completed runs and 2,100 training epochs, including three released-code activation arrangements and six modified configurations. The released GELU/GELU/HardSwish arrangement records mean daily Pearson correlation of 0.0408; the modified no-stock configuration reaches mean correlation 0.03517. Saved-state checks support mixed-precision compatibility testing, GPU-resident data delivery, and reproducible checkpoint analysis. A corrective investigation identifies sparse stock-branch activity associated with a large negative normalization-bias contribution. Freezing only this additive bias restores substantial activation coverage, but forecasting improvement varies across matched runs. The resulting contribution is an inspectable experimental workflow and an evidence-based account of execution, selection, and internal model behavior. Project repository: https://github.com/artemiskavin/Stock-Mixer.**

***Index Terms*—StockMixer, stock-return forecasting, reproducibility, mixed precision, normalization, model diagnostics**

I. Introduction

Next-day stock returns are noisy, nonstationary, and mutually dependent. Forecasting systems must capture temporal patterns and cross-stock relationships while supporting useful ranking decisions. Lower regression error need not improve selection of the highest-returning stocks, so evaluation requires both predictive and portfolio-oriented measures.

Fan and Shen's StockMixer combines indicator, temporal, and stock mixing through multilayer perceptrons and a market-width bottleneck [1]. Its compact architecture permits component comparisons and internal-state inspection on one graphics processor. The original paper provides the full derivation; this project concentrates on the executed implementation and completed experiments.

Our practical research gap is the connection between reported scores and inspectable training. The released trainer emits rounded metrics without exporting all-epoch weights, resumable state, or stock-activation measurements. These missing artifacts restrict analysis of checkpoint choice and branch behavior. Our extension supplies them and investigates observed stock-mixing sparsity.

We reproduce released configurations, compare documented component removals and recurrent controls, and test whether stock-axis normalization changes affect activation coverage and forecasting. Engineering improvements target transfer and synchronization costs while preserving supplied data, author loss, and epoch budgets. Workflow improvements are distinguished from predictive gains.

The contributions are:

- A completed NASDAQ comparison covering 21 main runs and 2,100 epochs, with consistent minimum-validation-loss reporting for saved checkpoints and recorded released-trainer results.
- An instrumented workflow with exact epoch metrics, all-epoch weight retention, state-complete resumption, numerical compatibility gates, GPU preloading, and measured execution comparisons.
- A stock-branch investigation that decomposes the effective normalization offset and tests a matched beta-zero intervention under corrected sampling and eager full precision.

II. Related Works

A. Mixing Architectures

MLP-Mixer alternates token- and channel-mixing perceptrons, enabling cross-location and cross-feature communication without attention or convolution in its vision setting [2]. Its image-token construction motivates matrix-based mixing but does not encode financial temporal order or market structure.

StockMixer adapts mixing to indicators, multi-scale temporal representations, and stock-to-market-to-stock exchange [1]. The paper evaluates NASDAQ, NYSE, and S&P500 with ablations and sensitivity studies. We reproduce the NASDAQ implementation and extend observable training behavior within a smaller computational scope.

B. Temporal and Relational Baselines

Long short-term memory networks propagate information through gated recurrent state [3]; gated recurrent units provide a related state-update mechanism [4]. They supply temporal controls here. Shared per-stock recurrent models do not explicitly exchange information across the universe, enabling comparison with architectures that add stock mixing.

Relational Stock Ranking combines ranking with temporal graph convolution over company relationships [5]. Its external relations and graph pipeline introduce requirements beyond a temporal encoder. Reconstructing the complete graph/hypergraph suite was outside our scope; LSTM, GRU, and LSTM plus stock mixing provide focused controls.

C. Position of This Project

Our extension asks whether cross-stock computation remains active and whether reported states can be recovered. Retained weights, numerical checks, and matched normalization diagnostics connect these questions to measurable behavior. Restored activity is assessed separately from improved prediction.

III. Proposed Methodology

A. Problem Formulation and Dataset

At position t, input $X_t \in \mathbb{R}^{N\times T\times F}$ contains $N = 1026$ stocks, $T = 16$ historical positions, and $F = 5$ features. Predicted price $\hat{p}_i$ is converted to return using final base price p_i^{base}:

$$\hat{r}_i = \frac{\hat{p}_i - p_i^{\text{base}}}{p_i^{\text{base}}}. \tag{1}$$

Supplied preprocessing, arrays, masks, and stock order are preserved. The 1,245 positions include validation targets 756–1007 and test targets 1008–1244 (237 days). The paper lists 273 test days; we use the dates in the released arrays.

Main reproduction experiments retain the released sampler: an offset array 0–755 is initialized once, shuffled in place each epoch, and its first 740 entries are used. Possible training targets are therefore 16–771, including 16 validation target positions. This overlap is documented rather than silently changed in a reproduction comparison. Corrective diagnostics separately restrict offsets to 0–739 and targets to 16–755, excluding reused validation labels. Valid historical input context is retained across split boundaries. Data were not reprocessed to obtain improved scores.

B. Architecture and Component Definitions

Figure 1 shows the executed full-model path from the released source [6]. A 16-step temporal/indicator path and a convolutionally downsampled 8-step path are combined with the raw temporal input. Their concatenation has 40 temporal positions. A shared feature projection produces $H \in \mathbb{R}^{1026\times 40}$. One price head acts directly on H; another acts on its stock-mixed representation. Their price outputs are summed.

The stock mixer applies LayerNorm across the stock axis, projects 1,026 stock inputs to market width 20, applies an activation, and projects back to 1,026 outputs. Full StockMixer contains 45,077 parameters. The released arrangements use GELU in both indicator perceptrons and HardSwish, GELU, or Sigmoid in the stock perceptron. In the modified matrix, surviving mixing perceptrons use HardSwish and recurrent gates remain native.

The no-indicator variant bypasses both indicator-perceptron residual terms. The no-TriU variant removes triangular temporal mixing while retaining the convolution and remaining paths; it is not removal of all temporal processing. The no-stock variant removes both the stock branch and its price head. LSTM and GRU have one shared recurrent layer with hidden size 32; the LSTM-plus-stock model adds the documented stock mixer and associated head. These definitions are fixed across repetitions. Full construction precedes parameter-free pruning where applicable, preserving common initial parameter values and construction order.

C. Author Loss and Frozen Checkpoint Rules

For validity mask m_i and realized return r_i, the retained objective is

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{MSE}} = \frac{1}{N}\sum_i [m_i(\hat{r}_i - r_i)]^2, \tag{2}$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{rank}} = \frac{1}{N^2}\sum_{i,j} \left[-(\hat{r}_i - \hat{r}_j)(r_i - r_j)m_i m_j\right]_+, \tag{3}$$

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{L}_{\text{MSE}} + 0.1\mathcal{L}_{\text{rank}}, \tag{4}$$

where $[a]_+ = \max(0, a)$. The full-N and full-N^2 denominators are preserved. They differ from the evaluator's valid-observation MSE denominator. Each full-market update forms a 1026×1026 ranking matrix, explaining appreciable computation despite the compact parameter count.

Every main run completes 100 epochs without early stopping. Adam uses learning rate 0.001, betas $(0.9, 0.999)$, epsilon 10^{-8}, zero weight decay, and no AMSGrad. Saved checkpoints are reported using minimum validation combined loss. Released-trainer rows retain previously recorded rounded-console metrics; console precision does not establish an exact recoverable checkpoint. Modified rows report arithmetic means and sample standard deviations across completed repetitions. Initialization uses the predefined NumPy/PyTorch seed pairs 123456789/12345678, 234567890/23456789, and 345678901/34567890 as applicable to the executed configuration.

The alternative frozen selection uses

$$\mathcal{E} = \{e : \mathcal{L}_{\text{val}}(e) \le 1.10\mathcal{L}_{\min}\}, \tag{5}$$

$$e_{\text{IC}} = \arg\max_{e\in\mathcal{E}} \text{IC}_{\text{val}}(e), \tag{6}$$

with exact ties broken by lower validation loss, then earlier epoch. The modified study's historical primary/secondary artifact labels are retained; the comparison tables consistently use lowest-loss results. Test metrics do not choose checkpoints, execution settings, or continuation.

D. Reproducible Recording and Efficient Execution

The workflow saves exact epoch metrics, all 100 weight states, and selection metadata. Resumable LAST state retains model, optimizer, RNG, offset permutation, modes, existing gradients, and AMP scaler where applicable. Source/data hashes identify configurations; preservation checks guard scientific state during recording and diagnostics. These recording,

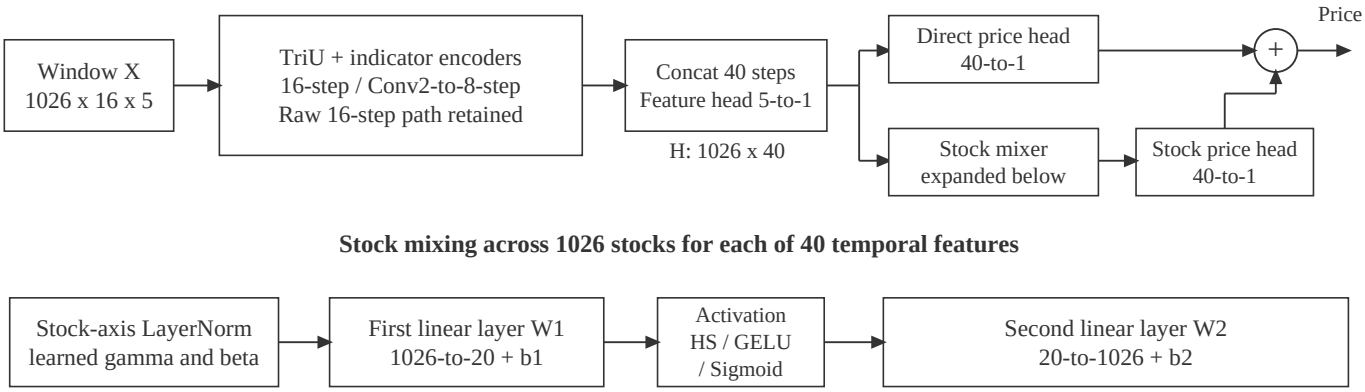


Fig. 1. Executed full StockMixer forward path and expanded stock mixer. The direct and stock price heads are added at the output. HS denotes HardSwish. The raw temporal branch and stock-axis dimensions follow the released source.

execution, and diagnostic extensions are retained in the project archive [7].

Figure 2 outlines the execution pipeline. Features, masks, base prices, and targets are transferred to the GPU once. Windows are sliced there using the unchanged shuffled order, avoiding repeated construction and transfer of four CPU tensors per update. Detached losses and predictions are buffered on device and transferred in batches, reducing synchronization while preserving aggregation order.

Automatic mixed precision (AMP) uses FP16 for eligible model operations. Model parameters, price heads, return conversion, and loss remain FP32; GradScaler supports the backward computation. Fifteen retained modified runs use AMP. GRU uses approved FP32 because its fixed-state FP16 gradient comparison gave relative L_2 error 0.592 and cosine 0.811, failing the fixed 0.05/0.99 gates. Compilation is applied only where numerical checks pass. No-indicator and no-TriU use eager seed-0 execution and compilation later; no-stock and LSTM-plus-stock use compilation. LSTM/GRU compile supported heads while retaining native recurrent cells. The modified pipeline disables TF32; released-code runs inherit installed defaults.

E. Stock-Branch Diagnostic and Matched Intervention

For stock-axis normalization, the first hidden preactivation can be decomposed as

$$\mathrm{LN}(x) = \gamma \odot \bar{x} + \beta, \tag{7}$$

$$z = W_1(\gamma \odot \bar{x}) + (W_1\beta + b_1), \tag{8}$$

where $\bar{x}$ is the standardized stock-axis input. The constant term $W_1\beta + b_1$ is distinct from total preactivation. Each hidden unit sums 1,026 weighted beta contributions; aligned signs can create a large shift even if individual terms are small. HardSwish has zero output for preactivation at or below -3, so the fraction below that boundary measures an inactive portion of the gate.

Corrected-sampler diagnostics train fresh all-HardSwish full models in eager FP32 for 100 epochs. The matched intervention freezes only the existing stock-axis LayerNorm bias beta at its initial zero value. Gamma and every other parameter remain trainable. Common initial tensors and per-epoch shuffle hashes are checked. Fixed probes, preactivation distributions, effective offsets, active-unit/window coverage, and branch-gradient norms are retained without changing training state. Selected states receive full training/validation activation censuses. This design tests branch behavior directly rather than assuming activity restoration must improve prediction.

F. Implementation Details and Project Scope

Experiments run on a Lenovo laptop with Intel Core i5-12450H (8 cores/12 threads), 16 GB RAM, and an NVIDIA RTX 4060 Laptop GPU with 8 GB VRAM. The environment is Windows 11, Python 3.10.21, PyTorch 2.9.1+cu128, CUDA runtime 12.8, cuDNN 9.10.2, NumPy 1.22.1, and NVIDIA driver 617.42. These are recorded project settings, not the historical environment of the paper.

NASDAQ-only evaluation keeps the repeated matrix and diagnostics manageable on one GPU. NYSE/S&P500 expansion, the complete graph/hypergraph baseline suite, broad lookback/market-width/scale searches, and ReLU/tanh sweeps are outside the completed scope. External relation preprocessing and exact paper ablation sources were not supplied with the preserved release. Effort was allocated to repeated modified configurations, retained artifacts, execution checks, and matched mechanism tests. The linked project repository is designated for the implementation and reproduction instructions.

IV. Results and Discussion

A. Experimental Setup and Evaluation

The main comparison covers 21 completed 100-epoch runs: three released-code activation configurations and six repeated modified configurations. Table I identifies recorded console values and saved selections. All comparisons use the same released-array test positions; follow-up evidence is not a newly reserved evaluation period.

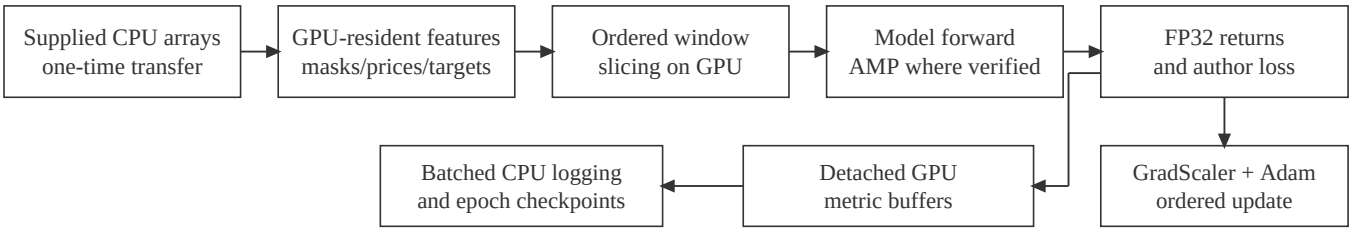


Fig. 2. GPU-resident execution, ordered window updates, and batched recording. AMP/GradScaler are bypassed for FP32 conditions. The optimizations target transfer, synchronization, and execution overhead; measured timing is reported separately.

Information coefficient (IC) is the official evaluator's mean daily Pearson correlation across stocks. Official-code RIC is the daily Pearson IC information ratio (mean divided by population standard deviation), not Spearman correlation. Precision@10 is the fraction of nonnegative realized returns among the selected top ten valid stocks. Gross Sharpe@5 uses equal-weight top-five returns, mean/population standard deviation times 15.87, without transaction costs. Evaluator MSE is a valid-mask average of squared return-prediction error. It is separate from both the training MSE component and combined author loss.

B. Quantitative Forecasting Results

The released GELU/GELU/HardSwish arrangement records the strongest displayed IC (0.0408), official RIC (0.482), and Precision@10 (54.8%) among its three arrangements. All-GELU records the highest gross Sharpe (1.72). The Sigmoid arrangement has lower IC (0.0225) and gross Sharpe (0.356), demonstrating that an activation change can affect ranking and the portfolio tail differently. These are recorded released-trainer outcomes rather than a basis for selecting an activation using test performance.

Within the modified group, no-stock achieves the largest mean IC (0.03517), official RIC (0.459), and gross Sharpe (1.128). Its 898 parameters also make it compact relative to the recurrent and stock-mixing variants. No-TriU has the largest IC spread across repetitions, with sample SD 0.01569. GRU has the lowest evaluator MSE but negative mean gross Sharpe. These absolute performance observations do not establish that removing a component caused a cross-protocol improvement. These experiments used different implementation settings. Results are exploratory, and differences across groups cannot be attributed solely to removing model components.

IC measures daily cross-sectional association and is unchanged by positive rescaling within a day. MSE additionally penalizes calibration and prediction magnitude. Consequently, low return-prediction error need not imply a strong stock ranking. GRU has slightly higher mean IC than LSTM (0.02875 versus 0.02751), yet lower gross Sharpe (-0.372 versus 0.395). The latter depends on return magnitude and variability among only five selections. Precision@10 counts nonnegative outcomes without measuring their size. Disagreement between these metrics is therefore informative rather than an evaluator inconsistency.

For context, the paper reports NASDAQ StockMixer IC 0.043 [1], compared with 0.0408 in the released HardSwish run: a descriptive difference of 0.0022, or about 5.1%. The paper describes RIC as Spearman correlation, whereas the released implementation uses the Pearson IC information ratio. This report follows the executed evaluator and does not treat the two RIC definitions as interchangeable.

C. Execution and Checkpoint Findings

Table II reports complete epochs, not pure kernel time. Compiled warm medians are approximately 20% lower for HardSwish and 38% lower for Sigmoid. HardSwish nevertheless has a longer setup-inclusive compiled total: startup can outweigh steady-state savings. Different seeds and nonconcurrent execution prevent isolation of an AMP, preloading, or compilation effect.

Preloading and batched recording target transfers and synchronization; AMP targets eligible arithmetic. Numerical gates determine usable paths, including the GRU FP32 exception. Faster execution and predictive benefit remain distinct outcomes.

A separate recording-only author-code comparison records test IC 0.02582928 against 0.04080 for the unchanged trainer, approximately 36.7% lower. Source audit found recording/saving additions as the only source changes. This observation does not establish that recording caused the difference: historical weights were unavailable and GPU determinism was not enforced.

Against minimum-loss selection in the 18 retained modified runs, the frozen 10%-tolerance rule improves test IC in 9 and decreases it in 9. The mixed finding motivates checkpoint research; win counts alone establish no overall benefit. The tolerance was not adjusted using test outcomes.

D. Stock-Branch Behavior and Learning Trajectories

Saved-state analysis of the recorded author-code run at its lowest-loss state finds a mean effective offset of -16.179: -15.885 from $W_1\beta$ and -0.294 from direct bias. Across 252 validation windows, 99.67% of gate entries are inactive. Nevertheless, 15 of 20 hidden units activate somewhere and only 19 windows are wholly inactive. The finding is severe sparsity rather than a globally dead stock branch. A constant stock-specific output can also remain after hidden gates deactivate.

TABLE I

FORECASTING RESULTS. RELEASED-TRAINER ROWS RETAIN ROUNDED RECORDED METRICS; MODIFIED ROWS ARE ARITHMETIC MEANS ± SAMPLE SD FROM LOWEST-VALIDATION-LOSS SAVED STATES. EVALUATOR MSE IS MULTIPLIED BY 10^4 AND P@10 IS A PERCENTAGE.

Configuration	Params	IC	Official RIC	MSE $\times 10^4$	P@10 (%)	Gross SR@5
Recorded released-trainer results						
GELU / GELU / HardSwish	45,077	0.0408	0.482	3.94	54.8	1.62
GELU / GELU / GELU	45,077	0.0368	0.414	3.94	53.5	1.72
GELU / GELU / Sigmoid	45,077	0.0225	0.242	4.61	53.0	0.356
Modified configurations: mean ± sample SD						
Without indicator mixing	44,957	0.02764 ± 0.00510	0.328 ± 0.042	4.115 ± 0.394	51.69 ± 0.89	0.812 ± 0.981
Without TriU mixing	44,881	0.01987 ± 0.01569	0.263 ± 0.188	3.915 ± 0.110	51.32 ± 0.52	0.896 ± 1.075
Without stock mixing	898	0.03517 ± 0.00591	0.459 ± 0.099	3.867 ± 0.044	52.38 ± 0.79	1.128 ± 0.510
LSTM	5,025	0.02751 ± 0.00531	0.300 ± 0.055	3.792 ± 0.007	51.69 ± 0.58	0.395 ± 0.544
GRU	3,777	0.02875 ± 0.01140	0.300 ± 0.117	3.787 ± 0.004	52.15 ± 0.81	−0.372 ± 0.440
LSTM plus stock mixing	49,196	0.02365 ± 0.00801	0.284 ± 0.089	3.824 ± 0.069	51.32 ± 1.13	−0.054 ± 1.285

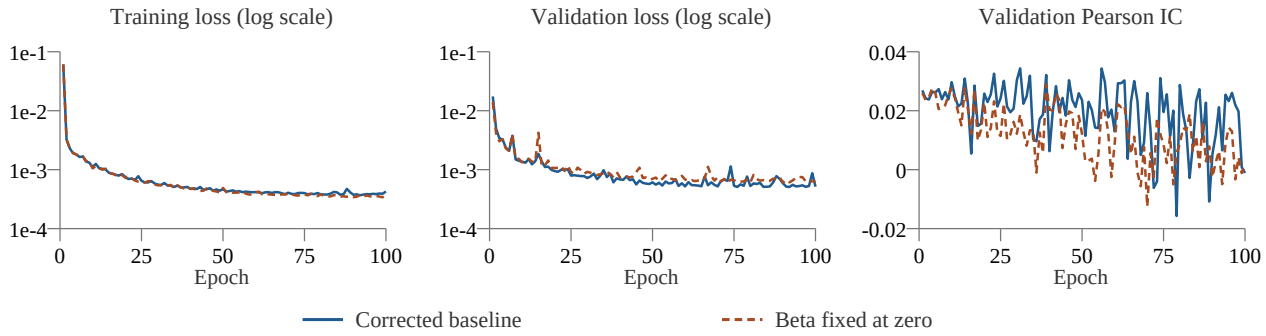


Fig. 3. Corrected-sampler eager-FP32 seed-0 trajectories from saved logs. Loss panels share logarithmic axes.

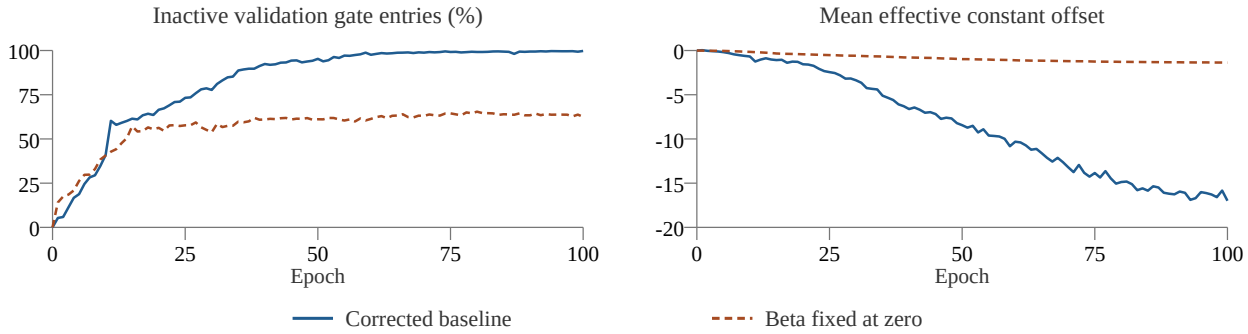


Fig. 4. Matched seed-0 fixed-probe inactivity and effective-offset trajectories, distinct from full-period censuses.

TABLE II

MEASURED FP16 EXECUTION TIMES IN SECONDS. WARM MEDIANS EXCLUDE EPOCH 1; TOTALS INCLUDE SETUP AND 100 EPOCHS, EXCLUDING INTERPRETER/IMPORT OVERHEAD.

	Warm epoch median		Total	
Condition	Compiled	Eager	Compiled	Eager
HardSwish	14.48	18.08	1900.8	1821.1
Sigmoid	13.93	22.38	1404.6	2836.4

Table III separates the activation outcome from the forecasting outcome. At selected beta-zero states, all 20 units retain some validation activity and no validation window is wholly inactive. Test IC increases from 0.02848 to 0.03053 for seed 0, but decreases from 0.02742 to 0.01244 for seed 1. Preventing near-total shutdown therefore does not consistently improve forecasting. Other learned parameters and representation changes remain relevant even after the additive normalization bias is fixed.

Figure 3 shows sharp early loss reductions but variable later validation IC. Loss convergence does not imply monotonic correlation improvement. Figure 4 shows a persistent beta-zero separation in activity and effective offset, supporting the behavioral finding independently of predictive superiority.

TABLE III
MATCHED CORRECTED-SAMPLER FP32 RESULTS AT EACH CONDITION'S LOWEST-LOSS CHECKPOINT. INACTIVITY IS THE VALIDATION GATE FRACTION AT OR BELOW -3.

Seed	Epochs: baseline / beta0	Baseline inactivity	Beta0 inactivity	Baseline test IC	Beta0 test IC
0	92 / 73	99.65%	64.83%	0.02848	0.03053
1	83 / 68	99.80%	60.04%	0.02742	0.01244

E. Discussion and Limitations

Exact records make checkpoints recoverable; fixed probes and full-period censuses localize branch behavior; matched initial values and shuffle replay support the beta intervention. These findings concern the implemented protocol and do not establish a universal StockMixer defect.

Main experiments preserve the released overlap, while corrective experiments remove target reuse. Sampling and precision changed together when establishing the clean FP32 baseline, so their individual causal effects are not isolated by that comparison. Beta-zero is subsequently tested within matched corrected settings. The current environment differs from the historical release stack and GPU determinism was not enforced [8]. Missing exact paper ablation sources are an implementation uncertainty, not an established cause of lower scores. The test period has already been inspected; follow-up results are exploratory and across-run variation is descriptive rather than proof of statistical significance.

V. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

This project combines StockMixer reproduction with exact recording, recoverable weights, full-state resumption, execution analysis, and branch diagnostics. Across 21 main runs and 2,100 epochs, released HardSwish records IC 0.0408 and modified no-stock reaches mean IC 0.03517. Error, correlation, precision, and portfolio Sharpe capture different forecasting properties.

Learned beta contributes to a large negative stock-MLP offset. Freezing it restores substantial activation coverage without consistently improving prediction. The 9–9 tolerance-selection result also motivates further investigation rather than a general benefit claim. Retained state remains a useful engineering contribution independent of score.

Future work should complete execution-matched repetitions with initial-weight and shuffle records, then evaluate a fresh period with transaction costs and portfolio-size sensitivity. NYSE/S&P500 expansion and separate sampling, precision, and normalization interventions would test generality. These priorities address limited repetition coverage, differing main protocols, target overlap, and the already-inspected test period while preserving the workflow's auditability.

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